

HOUSE No. 1969

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

PRESENTED BY:

Jeffrey N. Roy

To the Honorable Senate and House of Representatives of the Commonwealth of Massachusetts in General Court assembled:

The undersigned legislators and/or citizens respectfully petition for the adoption of the accompanying bill:

An Act concerning assault of a sports official.

PETITION OF:

NAME:	DISTRICT/ADDRESS:	DATE ADDED:
<i>Jeffrey N. Roy</i>	<i>10th Norfolk</i>	<i>1/15/2025</i>
<i>Patrick M. O'Connor</i>	<i>First Plymouth and Norfolk</i>	<i>3/25/2025</i>
<i>Thomas M. Stanley</i>	<i>9th Middlesex</i>	<i>4/15/2025</i>

HOUSE No. 1969

By Representative Roy of Franklin, a petition (accompanied by bill, House, No. 1969) of Jeffrey N. Roy relative to assaults upon sports officials. The Judiciary.

[SIMILAR MATTER FILED IN PREVIOUS SESSION
SEE HOUSE, NO. 1753 OF 2023-2024.]

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

In the One Hundred and Ninety-Fourth General Court
(2025-2026)

An Act concerning assault of a sports official.

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Court assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows:

1 Chapter 265 of the General Laws, as appearing in the 2020 Official Edition, is hereby
2 amended by adding the following section: -

3 Section 13O. (a) As used in this chapter the following words shall, unless the context
4 clearly requires otherwise, have the following meanings:

5 "Serious bodily injury", bodily injury which results in a permanent disfigurement,
6 protracted loss or impairment of a bodily function, limb or organ, or substantial risk of death.

7 "Sporting event", an organized competitive athletic activity between 2 or more
8 individuals.

9 "Sports official", an individual who officially administers or officially assists in
10 administering the rules at any sporting event, including, but not limited to, a referee.

11 (b) Except as otherwise provided in this section, a person who assaults, batters, or
12 assaults and batters an individual who performs his or her duties as a sports official immediately
13 before, during, or after a sporting event, or at any other time if the assault, battery, or assault and
14 battery directly arises from the sports official's execution of his or her duty as a sports official, is
15 guilty of a misdemeanor punishable by imprisonment for not more than 1 year or a fine of not
16 more than \$1,000.00, or both.

17 (c) A person who assaults, batters, or assaults and batters an individual who performs his
18 or her duties as a sports official immediately before, during, or after a sporting event, or at any
19 other time if the assault, battery, or assault and battery arises from the sports official's execution
20 of his or her duty as a sports official, causing the individual bodily injury requiring medical
21 attention or medical care, is guilty of a felony punishable by imprisonment for not more than 2
22 years or a fine of not more than \$2,000.00, or both.

23 (d) A person who assaults, batters, or assaults and batters an individual who performs his
24 or her duties as a sports official immediately before, during, or after a sporting event, or at any
25 other time if the assault, battery, or assault and battery arises from the sports official's execution
26 of his or her duty as a sports official, causing the individual serious impairment of a body
27 function, is guilty of a felony punishable by imprisonment for not more than 5 years or a fine of
28 not less than \$1,000.00 or more than \$5,000.00, or both.

29 (f) This section does not prohibit a person from being charged with, convicted of, or
30 punished for any other violation of law arising out of the same transaction as the violation of this
31 section.

32 (g) An entity that owns or operates a facility at which an individual performs duties as a
33 sports official shall post a sign in that facility that includes the text of subsections (1) to (3) and,
34 if requested by a sports official, shall provide an escort. An entity that violates this subsection is
35 responsible for a state civil infraction and may be ordered to pay a civil fine of not more than
36 \$500.00.